

TAX CULTURE ON YOUNG PEOPLE AGED 16 TO 18 IN THE LAS VIBORAS INDIGENOUS COMMUNITY

INTRODUCTION

According to (Velázquez Rodríguez, 2024), fostering a tax culture is crucial to reduce tax evasion. This study explores how young people in a predominantly informal labor community perceive the tax system, aiming to promote awareness and compliance. Labor informality in Mexico exceeds 50% (INEGI; Rojas Martinez, 2023), limiting social security and fiscal contributions. Informal trade harms economic development (Legarreta, 2017), while tax revenues fund essential services (Montano, 2019). The research contextualizes the lack of tax culture, reviews the tax system and promotion strategies, and presents the methodology, population, sample, and results.

CONTEXTUALIZATION OF THE PROBLEM

This study explores the challenges faced by 16- to 18-year-olds unaware of their tax obligations, highlighting issues with non-compliance and the importance of tax culture to prevent fines, sanctions, and financial problems. Many taxpayers lack knowledge about their duties and the use of tax revenues (Morales Tostado et al., 2019), with similar gaps observed in Ecuador (Burgos Zavala, 2020). In Mexico, only 40% of citizens actively pay taxes (Massud Martinez, 2024). According to (Escalante, 2015), seven out of ten people have a poor tax culture and struggle to see the benefits of paying taxes. A SAT survey revealed that many avoid taxes due to difficulty, lack of consequences, perceived corruption, or a missing culture of contributing (Overview of the Situation of the



Taxpayers in Mexico, 2012). Tax education promotes voluntary compliance and trust, while its absence fosters non-compliance (Buestán Barrera & Narváez Zurita, 2024). In Las Víboras, limited local employment and distant SAT offices restrict youth access to tax information, making registration seem like an obligation rather than a civic benefit.



METHODOLOGY

This study followed a mixed approach, combining quantitative and qualitative methods to provide a broad understanding of the impact of tax culture on youand tax experts—to achieve a more comprehensive view.

POPULATION AND SAMPLE.

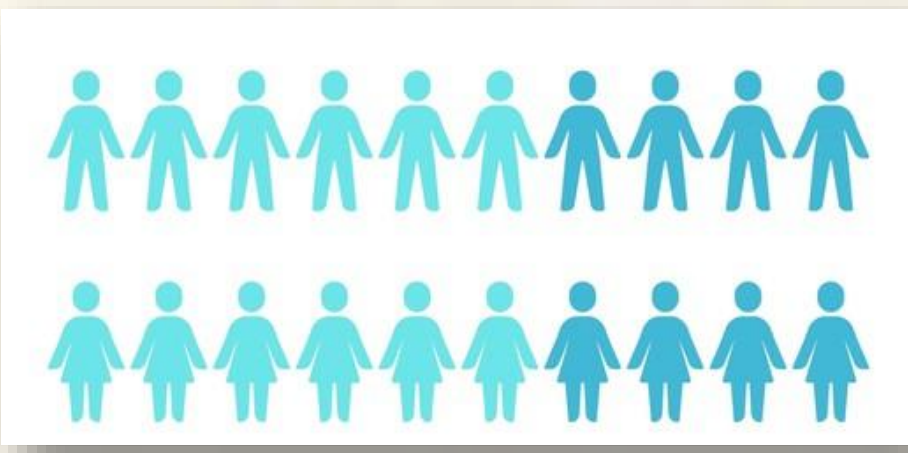
The study focused on the population of Las Víboras, an ejido in Tampamolón Corona, San Luis Potosí, located at an average altitude of 100 meters.



The main economic activities in Las Víboras are agriculture, livestock, commerce, and transportation. Key local traditions include “Xantolo” (November 1–9), the feast of “La Virgen de Guadalupe” (December 11), and year-end December festivities (local ejidal authorities, unpublished).

The sample included 16- to 18-year-olds from Las Víboras: 46 students and 15 employed youths, along with three accounting professionals for expert insight. Structured surveys measured knowledge, attitudes, and practices, while semi-structured interviews, observation, and bibliographic review captured perceptions and experiences from non-working students, young workers, and experts.

RELEVANT LITERATURE



Starting in 2024, the SAT implemented the Contributory Culture program to promote a positive attitude toward tax compliance from early education through teaching materials, tax fairs, and collaboration with the Ministry of Education (SAT, 2024). Such initiatives have helped shift the taxpayer's image from a mere obligated subject to an active agent of social development (Lopez & Rodriguez, 2016). Equity and accountability are essential to encourage voluntary compliance, as tax collection is a mechanism for national development. Developing a strong tax culture is crucial for reducing tax evasion (Velázquez, 2024). When the tax system operates with transparency and fairness, it strengthens the legitimacy of

authorities and citizens' willingness to comply voluntarily (Kerchler et al., 2008). While compliance based on fear of sanctions leads to passive or reluctant behavior, voluntary compliance—based on self-commitment—creates a more sustainable system rooted in shared civic responsibility within a democratic society (Roca, 2008).

Education is essential for fostering fiscal awareness, but it must first address why taxes are paid and where public resources are allocated. As (Montano, 2019) states, citizens must understand that taxes are beneficial rather than punitive, since tax revenue funds teachers, doctors, hospitals, schools, roads, and more. According to (Montiel, Sánchez, & Martínez, 2020), tax education should begin at an early age, teaching how taxes work and the shared responsibility of contributing to public goods. Likewise, (Compoverde Peñaranda, Narváes Zurita, & Solís Muñoz, 2024) warn that a lack of tax awareness can lead to evasion, reducing state income and creating social inequality.

RESULTS



RESULTS OF SURVEYS OF YOUNG STUDENTS

Surveys were applied to 47 young students in the age range of 16 to 18 years, the following results were obtained regarding their general knowledge of the tax system in Mexico.

Knowledge of the Tax System: 63.82% of those surveyed stated that they did not know what the tax system was, while 36.17% indicated that they did know it.

Knowledge about the function of the Tax Administration System: 48.94% of students indicated that they do not know what function the Tax Administration System (SAT) has, however, 51.06% of those surveyed claim to know what the function of the SAT is.

Payment of taxes and the types of taxes they pay: 87.23% indicated that they do not pay taxes, while 12.76% do pay. Regarding the type of taxes they pay, 12.76% said they paid the Value Added Tax (VAT), 65.95% said they did not pay taxes and 21.27% said they did not know if they paid taxes.

Knowledge of the Federal Taxpayer Registry (RFC): 55.31% of those surveyed do know what the RFC is, the other 44.65% do not know the term. Consequently, 46.80% know how to carry out the procedure to obtain the RFC, while 53.19% do not know what steps they must follow to obtain it.

Education on tax issues: 65.95% of young people indicated that if they take a subject related to taxes, the other 34.04 do not have related classes.

Perception regarding the benefits received from paying taxes: 23.39% indicated that the benefits obtained are collectively, with the paving of streets, infrastructure and government support, likewise, 31.91% indicated that the benefits come from social programs such as scholarships and pensions. 17.02 says that these benefits are in health, education and security in the country, however, 8.51% express that there are no benefits regarding the payment of taxes, and finally, 21.27% do not know what benefits they can obtain by paying taxes.

Notion about tax obligations: 57.44% claim to know what tax obligations consist of, the other 42.55% expressed ignorance of the subject.

Importance of complying with fiscal obligations: 70.21% consider that it is important to comply with fiscal obligations because paying taxes acquires resources for the country, 29.78% affirm that it is not important since they do not receive any benefits.

TECHNOLOGICAL REFLECTIONS

In an increasingly digitalized world, technology now serves as a crucial link between citizens and public institutions. In the tax context, it is essential for the Tax Administration System to adopt innovative tools such as Artificial Intelligence (AI) servers or optimized mobile applications to improve how taxpayers—especially young people—interact with their obligations. An AI server could immediately answer frequently asked questions, provide step-by-step guidance during procedures, and eliminate long waits for appointments or lines, saving time while reducing frustration and encouraging greater participation in tax culture. Likewise, intuitive apps with clear information, obligation reminders, tax simulators, and direct access to services would make compliance more accessible. Digitalization has a democratizing effect by removing geographical, economic, and time barriers, giving both youth and adults equal opportunities to stay informed and comply. Thus, technology not only streamlines processes but also strengthens trust in institutions and promotes a more accessible and conscious tax culture.